PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover Range Rover Classic

1970–1996 · RRC · LSE / County LWB

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Get under it before you look at the paint**
  The aluminium skins hide a steel frame. Check body mounts, the rear crossmember, frame sides, inner rear wheel arches, inner front wings and both sills. Pre-1983 trucks are mostly bolted together and easier to repair.
- [ ] **Lift the carpets and open the boot**
  Owners say to check under the front carpets for floor rot. Boot floors are suspect on post-1989 trucks, and the steel upper tailgate commonly rusts.
- [ ] **Listen to the V8**
  Listen for bottom-end knocks and timing-chain rattle. Look for weeping head gaskets — cheap if caught early — and be wary of anything that hints at a slipped liner, which means a rebuild.
- [ ] **Test the viscous coupling (1989-on)**
  Tyres scrubbing or chirping on tight, slow turns means the centre viscous coupling may have seized, turning the truck into a permanently locked 4×4. With the transfer case in neutral and the handbrake on, a jacked front wheel should turn slowly with resistance — not stay locked solid.
- [ ] **Interrogate the air suspension**
  On EAS trucks, pumps, height sensors and valve blocks fail and leak, and few parts are shared with the later P38A system. Many have been converted to coils — fine, as long as it was done with a proper kit.
- [ ] **Look for oily swivels**
  Leaking swivel-ball seals are chronic. Check the chrome balls for pitting and wet seals, and confirm the swivel housing has its own lubricant; it is separate from the front diff.
- [ ] **Check the small electrics**
  Window switches and seat controls often fail (usually cheap). On cars with electric seats, a leaking battery can kill the seat ECU and stop seats and mirrors moving.
- [ ] **Ask about LPG and the timing belt**
  One UK specialist recommends removing LPG conversions because they are often poorly fitted and can harm the engine. On 200Tdi and 300Tdi diesels, get proof the timing belt was changed in the last five years.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Fuel tank bottom corrosion**
  1987–1990 · NHTSA 95V-155
- [ ] **Fuel filter bracket corrosion**
  1987–1988 · NHTSA 88V-116

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **US-spec vs grey market**
  Factory US imports began on 16 March 1987 and were four-door only. Any US two-door, any pre-1987 truck, and any diesel came in through grey-market converters in the early 1980s or as a later 25-year import.

- [ ] **Brake pedal pivot circlip**
  1987–1988 · NHTSA 89V-012
- [ ] **Seat belt retractor pivot pin**
  1987–1988 · NHTSA 88V-034
- [ ] **Rear brake line chafe**
  1990 · NHTSA 91V-069
- [ ] **Brake light switch**
  1990 · NHTSA 91V-222
- [ ] **Wheelbase and suspension**
  Standard trucks have a 100-in (2,540 mm) wheelbase. The LSE / County LWB (1992 on) has a 108-in (2,743 mm) wheelbase, the 4.2 V8 and electronic air suspension; check whether a previous owner has fitted a coil conversion.
- [ ] **Transfer case**
  Pre-1989 trucks have a manual centre-diff lock (vacuum servo on the LT95, mechanical on the LT230). From 1989 a chain-driven Borg Warner box with a viscous coupling locks automatically, and a seized coupling makes the truck scrub on tight turns.
- [ ] **Hard dash vs soft dash**
  Until 1994 the Classic kept its original hard-plastic 'Airfix' dashboard. Run-out trucks got the Discovery-derived 'soft dash' with Rover 800 switches, the version enthusiasts call 'soft dash' models.
- [ ] **CSK**
  The 1990 CSK, named for Spen King, ran to 200 UK-built trucks: Beluga Black paint, chrome bumpers, silver coachlines, a recalibrated 3.9 V8 (185 bhp) and front and rear anti-roll bars. Australia separately built 400 CSKs based on the four-door Vogue.

NOTES

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